
How Can Trump Be A Fearsome Dictator If He's Such An Unpopular Loser?

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How Can Trump Be A Fearsome Dictator If He's Such An Unpopular Loser?



One big news item today is that, with the special election win of Adelita Grijalva to replace her late father Raúl Grijalva representing Arizona's Seventh Congressional District, the House of Representatives [will officially have enough votes](#) to force the release of the Epstein files. Republican Thomas Massie is leading that charge, despite threats from the White House, and a few other Republicans (and all Democrats) are sticking with him.

So that's fun.

Also there are [new renderings](#) of Donald Trump's fuckin' trash-ass butt-ugly White House ballroom for outer borough wannabes. The scale is so ridiculous, it looks like shit, it dwarfs the *actual* mansion, nobody knows why it's going to cost so much per square foot to build (money laundering) or why it needs to be 90,000 square feet when 10 would be fine (daddy's a size queen), just kidding guess we have *some theories* for the questions in the first part of this sentence.

We are sure [McMansion Hell](#) will have some opinions.

It's weird that Trump is still making all these moves like he's going to live in the White House forever, like President Alexandria Ocasio-Cortez won't host the most badass demolition day on the White House grounds (like they do on HGTV!) like four days after her inauguration, to let the American people show Trump what they think of his "improvements" to the People's House. It's like he doesn't even believe he's going to have to worry about there being an election in 2028 or something!

Of course, if that's the case, then that's *especially* weird, when you consider just how universally loathed and hated and mocked he currently is, and his numbers are just going down, down, down.

This tweet from Greg Sargent points out some things:



Greg Sargent

@GregTSargent · Follow



Trump absolutely cratering in new Quinnipiac poll:

Overall approval: 38-54

Approval on economy: 39-56

Approval on trade: 39-54

On National Guard into cities: 42-55

On immigration, his "best" issue: 41-55

Trump is weak, unpopular, and failing. Treat him that way:



Greg Sargent



@GregTSargent

Trump/MAGA are trying to gaslight us into believing that anti-Jimmy Kimmel America is vast and deep, that MAGA's grip on the culture is unshakable, that mobilization is futile.

This episode has demonstrated the opposite. Let's not forget it.

New from me:

newrepublic.com/article/200821...

The truth about this sleazy little game is that MAGA wants the best of both worlds. They wanted Trump and Carr to wield authoritarian pressure to bully networks into silencing someone whose speech about Mark—but also about Trump—they hate. And when that actually worked, they tried to recast it as a sign of the cultural times, as an indication that the culture is moving inexorably in Trump's direction.

Kannity insisted last week, for instance, that Kimmel had been removed because audiences were tired of “nonstop, never-ending hate-Donald-Trump.” In other words, the culture is registering a massive backlash to anti-Trump humor. The markets have spoken! But if that were the case, even Trump and Carr wouldn't need to wield the pressure of the authoritarian state to oust him.

Paradoxically enough, it was that use of authoritarian state power that provoked a massive cultural backlash—but in the opposite direction. Millions representing nearly half a million workers condemned Disney for giving to Trump's autocratic pressure. An astonishing range of figures with large followings drawn from across the culture spoke out, including the occasional conservative Republican. Data analyst G. Elliott Morris demonstrates that the backlash reached from the small-investor class to ordinary consumers. As *The New York Times* reports, Disney faced pressure from its customers, some of whom canceled Disney+ subscriptions and Disney World vacations in protest.”

new threats against Disney that could still work. Meanwhile, Nexstar and Sinclair are, for now, refusing to air Kimmel going forward. Could that hurt Kimmel? Maybe. But as the Reliable Sources newsletter points out, many Nexstar and Sinclair stations “are in small or mid-sized markets with more conservative political leanings,” while Kimmel’s “ratings and ad value comes from larger, liberal-leaning markets.”

So how big is anti-Kimmel America, and how deep into the culture does it really run, when it comes down to it?

Here's the bottom line: While Kirk's death was an appalling tragedy and he was unquestionably beloved by millions, the Trumpist right has baited the media into inflating Kirk's cultural and societal importance far beyond that, into deifying him as akin to a world historical martyr—and

liberty MAGA will not acknowledge is this: Trump's authoritarian suppression of disfavored speech are *themselves* triggering cultural outcry. And by all indications, it's larger than the push to censor imperfect speech about Kirk. Trumpists have been bluffing: Their overbearing threats and bluster do no snooker us into believing that the culture is lost, that Trump is unshakable, that mobilization is futile. For now, this episode has demonstrated precisely the opposite, and we shouldn't let our

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“Weak, unpopular and failing.”

Treat him that way.

(Also laugh at him when he gets on escalators and shout “Whooooooooooooooooaaaaaa!”)

First, that [Quinnipiac poll](#). It says that 79 percent of Americans believe the country is in political crisis, which includes 60 percent of Republicans. Now obviously those motherfuckers are fascists and Nazis and morons, so their definition of *why* is probably huffing some horse paste and Tylenol. But the whole country is shitbonkers, and nobody’s happy.

Seventy-one percent are worried about political violence. Fifty-eight percent don’t think that’s going to cool anytime soon. Fifty-four percent think it’s going to get worse.

Fifty-three percent think freedom of speech is in big danger. And so forth.

Everybody hates RFK Jr. (33 percent approval.)

Actually people DO think kids should be required to have vaccinations. (67-26.)

But we were talking about weak, unpopular and falling off escalators? Yeah, baby, have a screenshot from Quinnipiac:

PRESIDENT TRUMP

Thirty-eight percent of voters approve of the way Donald Trump is handling his job as president, while 54 percent disapprove, largely unchanged from Quinnipiac University's August 27 poll.

Voters were asked about Trump's handling of seven issues:

- immigration issues: 41 percent approve, while 55 percent disapprove, with 4 percent not offering an opinion;
- foreign policy: 40 percent approve, while 53 percent disapprove, with 7 percent not offering an opinion;
- trade: 39 percent approve, while 54 percent disapprove, with 7 percent not offering an opinion;
- the economy: 39 percent approve, while 56 percent disapprove, with 5 percent not offering an opinion;
- gun violence: 38 percent approve, while 54 percent disapprove, with 9 percent not offering an opinion;
- the Russia - Ukraine war: 33 percent approve, while 56 percent disapprove, with 11 percent not offering an opinion;
- the Israel - Hamas conflict: 31 percent approve, while 56 percent disapprove, with 13 percent not offering an opinion.

Ouch. If somebody with the last name Trump was more universally hated, they'd be Don Jr.

Let's see, everybody hates Trump on immigration, and that's the thing he was supposed to be good at. Everybody thinks he's an idiot on trade and economy. Specifically all those wars he loves to brag about ending, even though when you ask him which ones he's ended, he's like D U R R R R R R R R THE GREAT ARMENIAN CAMBODIAN BOWLING GREEN MASSACRE and everybody laughs at him?

Well his approval is swirling around the bowl of his golden toilet on Russia-Ukraine and Israel-Hamas, and it should go without saying that Donald Trump [also has not not ended any other wars.](#)

So that's cool.

Ever since the terrible assassination of He Whose Name We Are No Longer Typing, MAGA has been trying to convince the world that a new American saint has been beatified, and bullying anybody who suggests differently with threats of violence, financial ruin, and other kinds of reprisal. The amount of bullshit involved is breathtaking, but it should suffice to say that if you have to force people to agree that we've just lost an American hero, if you have to punish them for failing to mourn properly, then the victim of the horrific act wasn't actually all that beloved in the first place.

They really thought they had their moment teed up, desperately trying to use it as a Reichstag Fire to end free speech in the USA, [to push Jimmy Kimmel off the air](#) for saying *absolutely nothing* offensive or out-of-bounds of what a late-night comedian should be able to say in a free country.

But then, because these losers *always* overplay every single hand they are ever dealt, it blew up in their faces, and they fucking lost. The Disney boycott was one of the biggest and most successful — and *fastest* — [boycotts in recent history](#), and now it is a hot kitchen table issue for American people everywhere what a little bitch FCC Chair Brendan Carr is.

Before this they didn't know who he was in the first place!



[Jimmy Kimmel's Back, And He's Not Gonna Be Sorry](#)

[Marcie Jones](#)

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